FirstCut 2027 - Take 13 Official Submission Guidelines
Organized by FLAME University, Pune

ABOUT FIRSTCUT

Welcome to FirstCut, one of India's premier international student film festivals, organized by FLAME University, Pune. FirstCut provides a dynamic platform for young filmmakers across the globe, encouraging them to explore film as a medium of growth and change. In 2026, FirstCut Take 12 received 700+ submissions from students representing 75+ countries.

At the final event, shortlisted films will be screened for a live audience and evaluated by a distinguished jury from the Indian film industry. The screenings will be followed by engaging panel discussions and talks with renowned film personalities.

AWARDS & PRIZES

- Winners in each category receive a certificate and INR 30,000 cash prize.
- Transaction charges will apply to international winners.
- Submissions to FirstCut are FREE of charge.
- Attending the event is FREE and open to all.

KEY DATES FOR TAKE 13

- Opening Date: Tentative: 21 Oct 2026
- Final Deadline: 10 Jan 2027

ELIGIBILITY & CATEGORY TIME LIMITS

- Multiple Submissions: Students can submit multiple films across categories.
- Student ID: Submission of VALID STUDENT IDs IS MANDATORY at submission.
- Fiction: Max 20 minutes
- Non-Fiction: Max 40 minutes
- Animation: Max 10 minutes
- Nano: Max 2 minutes
- Crew Eligibility: Directors, cinematographers, editors, scriptwriters, and sound designers must be current undergraduate or master's students or recent graduates (graduated within 2026). Actors and other crew members do not need to be students. No limit per institution.

PRODUCTION GUIDELINES & COMPLETION DATES

- Films must be original (music, visuals, scripts). No copyrighted material.
- Projection-quality picture and sound are preferred.
- All films, including those in English, MUST have English subtitles.
- Content must adhere to legal standards (no obscenity, defamation, copyright infringement, or incitement of communal disharmony).
- Completion Dates: Fiction, Non-Fiction, and Nano films must be completed on or after January 30, 2026. Animation films on or after January 30, 2025.

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

- Submit via FirstCut's website or FilmFreeway. Submit on 1 platform only.
- Films must be submitted as downloadable links via Google Drive, Vimeo, or Hidden YouTube.